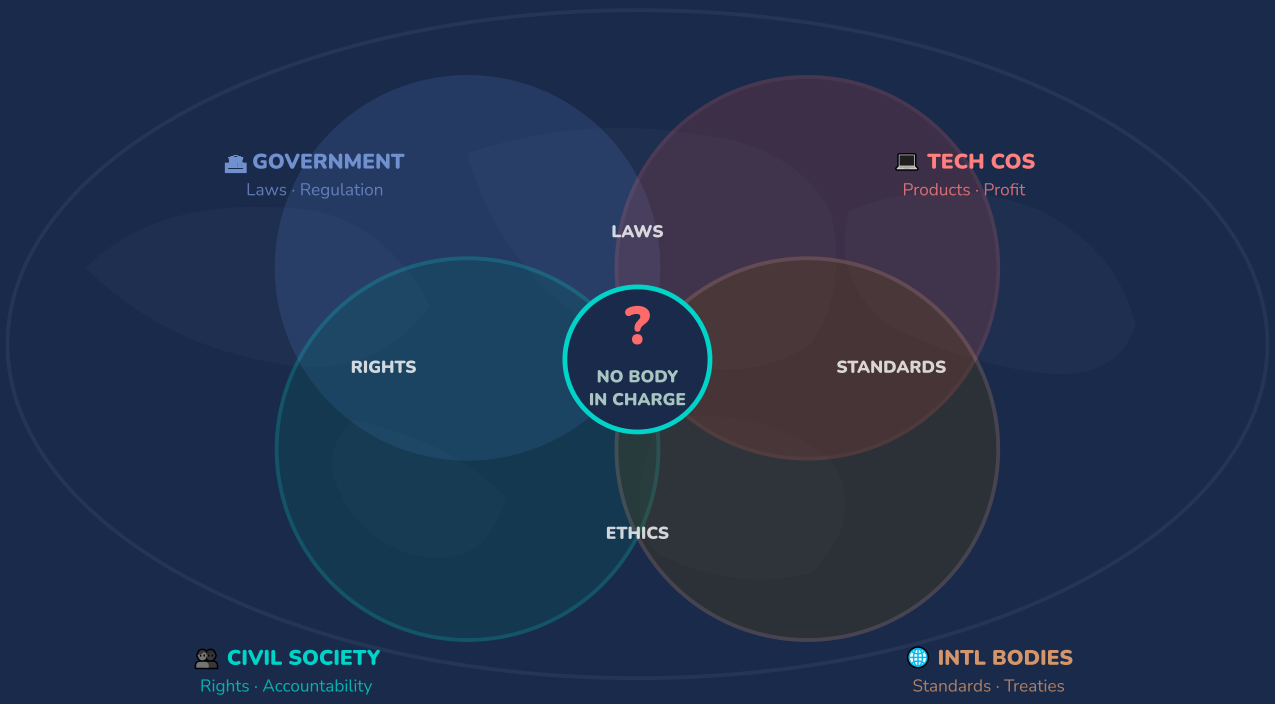
WHO MAKES THE RULES FOR AI?

Who decides how AI is built, deployed, and controlled?



NEGOTIATE | REPRESENT | GOVERN

WHO MAKES THE RULES FOR AI?

AI governance is one of the most important conversations happening in the world right now. This card gives students a concrete experience of why it is hard — multiple actors with different interests, operating across national boundaries, on timescales that don't match technology development.

MAIN ACTIVITY

1. Students receive stakeholder cards: EU government, US tech company, Chinese government, civil society NGO, small country with no AI industry, academic researcher.
2. A UN-style negotiation: they must agree on 3 global AI rules by the end of the session. A facilitator (teacher or student volunteer) chairs the session.
3. Each stakeholder has a secret priority (e.g. "ensure AI favours our national industry," "prioritise civil liberties," "prevent AI from being used as a weapon"). They must pursue their priority without revealing it.
4. Debrief: what rules were agreed? Who had to compromise? Were any priorities irreconcilable?

MATERIALS

- Stakeholder cards with secret priorities (6 roles)
- Negotiation agenda template
- Rule-drafting template (3 rules)
- Facilitator guide for teacher/student chair
- Debrief reflection cards

REFLECTION

- Why is global AI governance so difficult?
- Whose values should global AI rules reflect?
- What happens when countries have incompatible visions of what AI should do?
- Who is not at the table — and why does that matter?

REALITY CHECK

There is no global AI governance body with enforcement power.

The EU, US, China, and other major actors are developing different and sometimes incompatible AI regulatory frameworks. International coordination is slow; technology is fast. This gap is the central challenge of our era.

GO DEEPER

Governance Game

Scan to play →

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